



A WALK AROUND THE BLOCK · MINI LESSON № 1

Triggers as *Teachers*

The heat rises. The jaw sets. The story starts writing itself. What if that moment isn't an enemy at all — but a teacher, arriving with the exact lesson you've been avoiding?

The man in the green vest

Two flaggers at a construction site gave Johnny opposite directions — one waving him through, one screaming at his windshield, arms going like a windmill. Happy music on the radio; nothing happy under his ribs. It took a few miles of freeway before he could ask the only useful question: **what was in that moment for me to learn?**

That's a trigger. And we've been taught to treat triggers like enemies — something to manage, to hide, to apologize for. Here is a different possibility: the trigger is a **teacher**, showing up uninvited with the exact lesson you've been avoiding.

The man in the green vest didn't *create* what happened in Johnny. He **found** it. Triggers don't point at the person in front of you — they point at something **in you** that's asking to be seen: a tender place, an old story, a boundary crossed long before today.

*“Bravery faces down the danger around you.
Courage transforms the world within you.”*

— JOHNNY GRAF

A trigger *feels* like outer danger. That's the disguise. It's actually an invitation to inner work — and ignored teachers don't give up. They get louder: **first a feather, then another feather, then a rock, then a truck.** The lesson keeps rising until we finally sit down for class.

Ten seconds, no mat required

- 1 **Pause.** Don't fix, don't flee, don't fire back. One breath is enough to break the spell.
- 2 **Name it, gently:** *"Something in me just got touched."* Naming moves you from inside the storm to beside it.
- 3 **Ask the student's question:** *"What are you here to teach me?"* You don't have to like the teacher. You just have to stay for the lesson.

THREE JOURNAL PROMPTS

1. Think of a recent trigger. What did you feel first — and where in your body did it land?

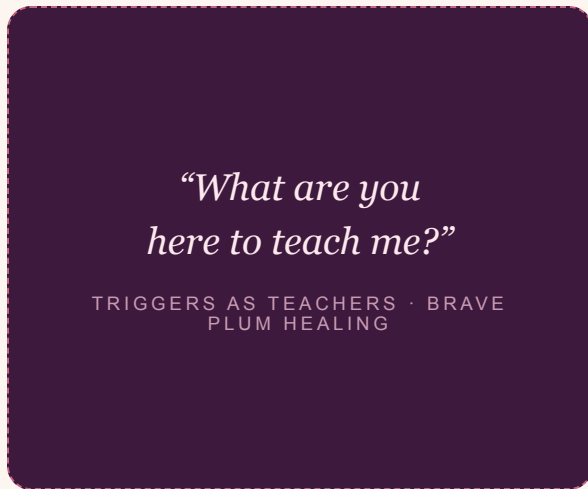
2. If that trigger were a teacher, what lesson might it have been holding for you?

3. Has this same teacher visited before — as a feather, a rock, or a truck? What might sitting down for class look like this week?

TAKE IT WITH YOU

Two cards for your pocket or mirror

Cut along the dashed lines. Keep one where the heat tends to rise — the car, the desk, the kitchen — and give the other away to someone who needs a gentler teacher.



The goal was never to have no triggers. The goal is a life where nothing in you has to stay hidden — where even the man screaming at your windshield gets to be one of your teachers.

When you're ready to go deeper, the door's open: a free 30-minute discovery call at **braveplumhealing.com**. No pressure, ever.

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